

RELATING SELF-CARE DEFICITS TO MY ADDICTION

GOALS OF THE EXERCISE

1. Understand the relationship between addiction and self-care deficits.
2. Learn the benefit of addressing self-care and how it relates to recovery.
3. Experience increased social acceptance because of improved appearance and/or functioning in the area of self-care.

ADDITIONAL HOMEWORK THAT CAN BE APPLICABLE TO CLIENTS WHO EXPERIENCE SELF-CARE DEFICITS—PRIMARY

- Assessing My Needs
- Assessing Self-Care Deficits
- Building My Support Network
- Coping with Addiction and Thought Disorders
- Filling In the Gaps
- How Independent Am I?
- Identifying and Using Community Resources
- Physical and Emotional Self-Care
- Using My Support Network
- Working toward Independence

ADDITIONAL PROBLEMS FOR WHICH THIS EXERCISE MAY BE USEFUL

- Psychosis
- Self-Care Deficits—Secondary
- Substance-Induced Disorders

SUGGESTIONS FOR PROCESSING THIS EXERCISE WITH THE CLIENT

The “Relating Self-Care Deficits to My Addiction” exercise is designed as a follow-up to the first exercise in this section, “Assessing Self-Care Deficits.” It can be assigned and processed as a motivational activity. For clients with severe deficits, it is important that they begin to make behavioral

changes to their self-care and that measurable progress is noted before attempting to achieve further insight into its relationship to their addictive lifestyles. It can also be used to facilitate discussions related to relapse-prevention planning.

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Primary self-care activities include behaviors related to hygiene; grooming; diet; interpersonal, social, and communication skills; keeping a safe and clean living environment; and responding to crises appropriately. Addictive lifestyles can interfere with functions like these in many ways. This exercise will help you learn more about how addiction has affected your own ability to take care of yourself.

1. What role do you think your addictive behaviors have played in causing you to neglect your primary self-care activities?

2. Secondary gains are benefits we obtain without there being an apparent reason for doing things. What secondary gains have you experienced when you neglected your self-care (e.g., getting others to do things for you, avoiding intimacy or uncomfortable situations)?

3. What negative consequences have come from continued neglect of primary self-care activities in your life?

4. If you've done the exercise titled "Assessing Self-Care Deficits," you've identified some areas in which you feel you need to make improvements in your self-care. Please refer to your responses from that exercise to answer these questions.
 - a. What benefit(s) will come, or have already come, from improving your self-care in these areas?

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- b. How does paying attention to these self-care activities support your recovery?

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- c. What progress have you made so far in improving your self-care? What's your next step?

Be sure to bring this handout with you to your next therapy session, and be prepared to discuss your thoughts and feelings about the exercise.